

Submission to One Nation: Common Sense Roadside Reform for Medical Cannabis Patients

Cover Letter

To: Senator Pauline Hanson & The One Nation Team

I am writing to propose a common-sense reform to our current roadside drug driving laws.

As it stands, our current system is failing our veterans, our chronic pain sufferers, and the everyday Aussie battlers who are trying to follow the law. We are currently treating law-abiding, medically-prescribed patients the same way we treat illicit drug users. This is not about being "soft on drugs"; this is about stopping the bureaucratic overreach that is stripping hardworking Australians of their licences and their livelihoods when they pose no threat on our roads.

I have developed a two-phase framework that maintains strict law-and-order standards while ensuring our genuine, long-term patients are not unfairly persecuted.

Executive Summary: A "Fair Go" Framework

The Problem: A System That Doesn't Catch Real Criminals

Our current laws are failing because they don't test for *impairment*; they test for *presence*. A person who uses legal medicine is being pinged for THC metabolites that have been in their system for days, while someone who is genuinely dangerous and impaired on illicit substances can sometimes slip through the cracks. We need to stop wasting police time on people who are simply taking their prescribed medicine and focus on real road safety.

The Solution: A Two-Phase "Common Sense" Approach

We propose a two-phase system that balances strict discipline with fairness for those who have proven their stability.

Phase 1: The 12-Month "Zero-Tolerance" Probation (Law & Order)

Any person who starts a medical cannabis prescription must operate under an absolute, iron-clad, zero-tolerance rule for the first 12 months.

- **No exceptions.**
- **No excuses.**
- If you fail a roadside test, you lose your licence.

This ensures that any new patient who cannot handle their medicine responsibly is dealt

with immediately. It serves as a filter: only those who prove they can be responsible, stable, and compliant progress to the next phase.

Phase 2: Impairment-Based Fairness (The "Fair Go")

After 12 months of clean driving and medically supervised compliance, a patient should be assessed on *actual impairment*—just like we currently treat patients on strong painkillers, opioids, or sedatives.

- If you are a long-term, stable patient who is not impaired, you should be allowed to drive.
- If you are impaired, you are off the road.

This removes the "bureaucratic madness" of punishing people for trace amounts of medicine that don't affect their ability to drive.

Why This Appeals to One Nation Values:

1. **It Supports Our Veterans:** Thousands of our veterans use medical cannabis to manage the trauma of their service. They shouldn't have to choose between their medicine and their ability to work.
2. **It Cuts Red Tape:** We are moving away from a lazy, "one-size-fits-all" test to a targeted system that actually tests for safety rather than just ticking a bureaucratic box.
3. **It's Disciplined:** By insisting on the 12-month "zero-tolerance" phase, we ensure that this policy cannot be exploited. It forces patients to prove their responsibility before they earn the privilege of the Phase 2 assessment.

We need a policy that respects the law-abiding citizen and focuses police resources on where they are actually needed—keeping our roads safe from the truly dangerous.

I urge One Nation to champion this common-sense reform.